Validation & Business Rules — Client Checklist

Every rule below was inferred from the workbook, not stated in a spec — none of it came from Fairhaven telling us "a charge rate can't be below cost rate" or "job numbers look like J-3001." We read the data and built rules to match what it showed us. That means some of these could be wrong: a coincidence in this particular workbook that isn't actually a rule the business follows, or a rule the business follows but didn't happen to break in this data.

Please go through each item and mark it ✅ **Correct** or ✏️ **Needs changing** (with a note on what it should be instead). Items marked ⚠️ are ones we're specifically unsure about and would like an explicit answer on, even if the answer is "yes, that's right."

Client

#	Rule	✅ / ✏️	Notes
1	Name is required.		
2	Phone number is optional. When entered, it's automatically reformatted to standard Australian style — `04XX XXX XXX` for mobiles, `0X XXXX XXXX` for landlines — no matter how it's typed in (with or without spaces, dashes, a `+61` prefix). Numbers that don't fit a recognisable 10-digit Australian shape are left exactly as typed.		
3	Email is optional, but if entered must be a valid email address and must be **unique** — no two clients can share one.		
4	⚠️ Clients are matched/de-duplicated by **email address**, not by name — so "Harrow Property Care" and "Harrow Property Care Pty Ltd" are treated as the *same* client if their email matches. If two clients have no email on file, they're matched by name instead. Is email always a reliable match key for you, or do you have clients who share a mailbox (e.g. a shared office inbox) but are genuinely different accounts?		

Technician

#	Rule	✅ / ✏️	Notes

5	Name is required.		
6	⚠️ Role is optional, but limited to exactly two options: **Technician** and **Senior Technician** — the only two values found anywhere in the staff list. If there are other role titles used internally (apprentice, subcontractor, etc.), this list needs to grow.		
7	Licence Number is optional, free text.		
8	Active is a yes/no flag; new technicians default to **Active**.		
9	Cost Rate (what a technician costs the business per hour) is optional, must be **$0 or more**.		
10	Charge Rate (what the client is billed per hour, ex GST) is optional, must be **$0 or more**.		
11	⚠️ **Charge Rate must be greater than or equal to Cost Rate** — the form blocks saving a technician who'd be billed out below what they cost. Is this always true, or are there legitimate cases (e.g. a loss-leader job, an apprentice being trained on paid time) where charge could be set below cost?		
12	⚠️ A technician who logs hours in the Timesheets but isn't on the Staff List is automatically created as a new technician record with **no rate information** at all (not zero — blank/unknown), rather than blocking the import. Is that the right default, or should an unlisted technician block the import for manual review instead?		

Job

#	Rule	✅ / ✏️	Notes
13	⚠️ Job Number is required, must be **unique**, and must match the pattern `J-` followed by 3 or more digits (e.g. `J-3001`) — inferred because every job number in the workbook follows this exact shape. Is this the permanent numbering scheme, or could future jobs use a different prefix/format?		
14	⚠️ Status is required and limited to four fixed options — **Open, Scheduled, In Progress, Complete** — normalised from free-text wording in the sheet (e.g. "done" and "completed" both became "Complete"). Defaults to **Open** for new jobs. Is this the complete list of statuses the business actually uses?		

15	Client is required for new jobs created through the panel. (The one exception: "legacy" jobs auto-created from orphaned timesheet rows during import have no client — see #19 below.)		
16	Lead Technician is optional. The dropdown only offers technicians currently marked **Active** — an inactive technician can't be assigned as lead on a new/edited job.		
17	⚠️ Job Type is optional, limited to four fixed options — **Breakdown, Scheduled Maintenance, Install, Repair** — also inferred from the data. Is this the complete list?		
18	Amount (ex GST) is optional, must be **$0 or more**.		
19	Date Completed, if set, **cannot be earlier than** Date Booked.		
20	⚠️ A timesheet row referencing a job number that doesn't exist in the Jobs sheet automatically creates a placeholder "legacy" job stub (no client, status Open, a note explaining it's a carry-over) rather than being rejected. Should this instead block the import so someone can investigate the missing job first?		

Time Entry (Timesheets)

#	Rule	✅ / ✏️	Notes
21	Technician is required.		
22	Job is required.		
23	Date is required.		
24	Hours is required and must be a **whole or half-hour** value (7 or 7.5 — not 7.25), inferred because every hours value in the workbook is a whole or half number.		
25	⚠️ **Negative hours are allowed**, specifically so a mistaken entry can be corrected by logging an offsetting negative amount rather than editing or deleting the original row (e.g. one entry of `+4` and a later one of `−4` net to zero, and both stay visible). Is that how you'd want corrections handled day to day, or would you rather technicians/office staff edit the original entry directly?		
26	Notes is optional, free text.		
	⚠️ Abbreviated or differently-spelled technician names in the Timesheets sheet (e.g. "D. Nguyen") are automatically matched to		

27	Timesheets sheet (e.g. "D. Nguyen") are automatically matched to the full Staff List name ("Danh Nguyen") by first-initial + surname. Is first-initial + surname a safe matching rule for your staff, or could two technicians share an initial and surname combination?		

Items 4, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 17, 20, 25, and 27 are also written up in more detail in `FINDINGS.md`, with the specific rows from the workbook that led to each decision.